

1. inaturalist-clumper 0.1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-15T23:53:11+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/15/inaturalist-clumper/#atom-everything>

Release: inaturalist-clumper 0.1 Part of the infrastructure I use for publishing my iNaturalist sightings on my blog . I've been running this in production for a few weeks now, inspiring some iterations on how it works, so I decided to ship a 0.1 release. You can see an example of the output in this JSON file . Tags: projects , inaturalist

2. Western Gull, Rock Pigeon

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-15T14:42:00+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/15/sighting-361818285/#atom-everything>

Western Gull, Rock Pigeon, in Los Angeles Area (custom), CA, US I went for a bird walk in the morning before PyCon, and we spotted a local seagull enjoying a Starbucks.

3. QR code generator

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-15T04:00:49+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/15/qr-code-generator/#atom-everything>

Tool: QR code generator Claude helped me build this tool for creating QR codes, for both text/URLs and for connecting to WiFi networks. Tags: vibe-coding , tools , generative-ai , ai , llms

4. The Talk Show: ?A Sociopathic Father?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-16T01:38:00Z

Link: <https://daringfireball.net/thetalkshow/2026/05/15/ep-447>

Adam Lisagor returns to the show to talk about Hovercraft , his new virtual presentation camera app for Mac, and how he?s developing it with AI coding tools. Also, delicious Japanese spite sandwich cookies. Sponsored by: Parcel : Track your packages in one place, with native apps for iPhone, iPad, Apple Watch, and Mac. Scribe : Instantly capture and optimize workflows so your teams and AI agents do their best work. Squarespace : Save 10% off your first purchase of a website or domain using code TALKSHOW . ?

5. Greg Brockman Officially Takes Control of Products at OpenAI, a Very Stable Well-Run Company

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-16T01:37:57Z

Link: <https://www.wired.com/story/openai-reorg-greg-brockman-product/>

Maxwell Zeff, reporting for Wired (News+ link): OpenAI told staff on Friday that it would reorganize the company as part of an ongoing effort to unify its product offerings, Wired has learned. OpenAI cofounder and president Greg Brockman will now lead the company?s product strategy, in addition to his work on AI infrastructure, OpenAI confirms to Wired. Brockman was previously assigned to oversee OpenAI products on an interim basis while the CEO of AGI deployment, Fidji Simo, was on medical leave; the change is now official. [...] The company tells Wired that Simo remains on medical leave, and expects her return, noting that she worked directly with Brockman on these organizational changes. Yours truly, last month : OpenAI?s work environment seems not merely overwhelming, but torturous. I have no reason to believe Simo?s medical leave is anything but a legitimate medical leave, but I wouldn?t be surprised if she never comes back. (What?s the point of being CEO of AGI deployment when there is no AGI to deploy?) Her title might as well be ?CEO of Technology That Doesn?t Exist?. ?

6. Wanton Destruction of CBS Property

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-15T20:12:09Z

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eBKWKu2Rqxc>

?Good night and good luck, motherfuckers.? ?

7. The case of the CreateFileMapping that always reported ERROR_ALREADY_EXISTS

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260515-00/?p=112327>

Maybe because it already exists? The post The case of the CreateFileMapping that always reported ERROR_ALREADY_EXISTS appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Recovering the state of xorshift128

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 12:34:29 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/15/xorshift128-state/>

I've written a couple posts lately about reverse engineering the internal state of a random number generator, first Mersenne Twister then lehmer64. This post will look at xorshift128, implemented below.

```
import random # Seed the generator state a: int = random.getrandbits(32) b: int = random.getrandbits(32) c: int = random.getrandbits(32) d: int = random.getrandbits(32) MASK = [?]
```

 The post Recovering the state of xorshift128 first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Language Registries Are Unstable by Default

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-15T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/15/language-registries-are-unstable-by-default.html>

Running `pip install requests` or `npm install react` against the public registry is the same operation, structurally, as running `apt install -t unstable` against Debian `sid` , and nobody involved talks about it that way. I don't mean "unstable" as a synonym for buggy, I mean it in the specific sense Debian has used since the late nineties: a pool of packages where new versions land the moment a maintainer uploads them, with no promotion gate, no minimum residency time, and no quality bar between the upload and your machine. On a language registry any authenticated publisher can push any version at any time, the index updates within seconds, and any resolver that hasn't been deliberately configured otherwise will start selecting it on the next run. The path from a maintainer pressing enter to an enterprise CI pipeline executing the result has nothing in it except whatever the consumer remembered to set up, and most consumers haven't set up anything. Debian `sid` exists on the explicit understanding that you don't point production at it. The default `sources.list` on a Debian install points at `stable` , where packages have spent months in testing , which they only entered after a mandatory st...

10. Search engine results are truly terrible

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/misc/search/>

A few months ago, I had the displeasure of trying to use the modern web without an ad-blocker. Even though it's ubiquitous among computer nerds, ad blocking is quite rare even in other technical fields. This got me wondering how search engines perform without all the tricks people do to get better results. As a test, I wrote a few queries for... common software: ad blocker ... obscure, but easy to find information: What is the lowest K-alpha emission energy of Molybdenum? ... and few normal(-ish) questions: What photodiode circuit should I use? How do airplane wings work? Why are brushed motors most efficient at high speeds? Asking a search engine questions is almost never the best way to find good information, but it's what I've seen a lot of people do. To replicate the experience of a normie/victim I made sure to include the AI summary, sponsored results and info boxes:

```
.good {background-color: #050;} .ok {background-color: #440;} .bad {background-color: #520;} .crap {background-color: #700;} td {width: 17%; } li::marker { color: var(--em-color); } li { margin-top: 1em; } Ad blocker Molybdenum Photodiode Wings Motors Google Bad Ok Crap Ok Bing Bad Ok Crap Ok Crap Kagi C...
```

11. UK Government Kicks Out Palantir

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 05:34:03 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/uk-government-kicks-out-palantir/>

The UK Government, for all its faults, is pretty good at publishing contracts it has awarded.

That's why I get depressed when I see rage-bait nonsense about how companies have been awarded "Top Secret" deals. Right now you can go to <https://www.contractsfinder.service.gov.uk> and search for whichever boogymonster has you riled up. You might want to argue that the company is corrupt, incompetent, or ?

12. Premium: What If...We're In An AI Bubble? (Part 1)

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 16:44:27 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-what-if-were-in-an-ai-bubble-part-1/>

Every day I read some sort of wrongheaded extrapolation about the future of AI ? that today's models are somehow indicative of AGI creating a ? permanent underclass ? of people that stops people from building software companies, or really doing any kind of job on the computer:

13. Eric Jang ? Building AlphaGo from scratch

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 16:04:58 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/eric-jang>

AlphaGo is still the cleanest worked example of the primitives of intelligence: search, learning from experience, and self-play.

14. Pluralistic: No one wants a permanent gerontocracy (15 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 12:38:04 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/15/not-ok-boomer/>

Today's links No one wants a permanent gerontocracy: The one policy everyone agrees on. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Wolfengetmo; Facebook condemns Google privacy invasion; Michael Moore on bin Laden; TSA v babies; Tendril perversion; "Buy now"; Uber Ch(eats); Who Broke the Internet (II)? Upcoming appearances: Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. No one wants a permanent gerontocracy (permalink) Perhaps the most demoralizing part of Trumpismo is the fear that the people around you are so cruel and senseless that they approve of the violence, the racism, the pig-ignorant lies and rampant theft:

<https://www.techdirt.com/2025/07/08/who-goes-maga/> One of the things keeping me going in these dark days is the pollster G Elliot Morris, whose "Strength in Numbers" newsletter is a reliable, robust and nuanced source of information about the way other people ? including Trump's base ? feel about him from moment to moment. Reading items like "A reminder: Very few people support Donald T...

15. Vitamine D: De motorolie voor ons afweersysteem

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 13 Sep 2020 10:43:38 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/vitamine-d-de-motorolie-covid-19/>

We horen veel over hoeveel mensen er nu besmet raken met COVID-19. Tegelijk viel het tot begin oktober erg mee met de ziekenhuisopnames en sterfgevallen. Ik kan ook niet verklaren hoe dat precies komt (het is niet alleen leeftijd), maar ik wil het in dit artikel wel hebben over ?de zonlichtvitamine?, vitamine D. Want nu in september hebben we net een zomer lang zon gehad, en in maart kwamen we vers uit de winter.

16. Galileo's Proposed Authentication Algorithm: Part 2

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2020 10:43:09 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/galileos-authentication-algorithm-part-2/>

Recapping from part 1: Galileo will soon add cryptographic signatures to the navigation messages. These cryptographic signatures are made with symmetric cryptography, which means clever techniques are required to prevent receivers from impersonating the network. The key to the technique is first signing messages, and only later disclosing the key used for the signatures, thus invalidating it for further use. Receivers can however verify that earlier signatures were indeed made with that key.

17. Galileo's Proposed Authentication Algorithm: Part 1

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2020 20:50:09 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/galileos-authentication-algorithm-part-1/>

Position, velocity and time (PVT) information can be a ?nice to have?, but in other circumstances knowing place and time has legal or military importance as well. Heavy vehicles for example are typically outfitted with tachographs that track driver speed and/or location. This has importance for rest regulations, but also to check if loads are actually from where they say they are. Our Global Navigation Satellite Systems so far are broadcasting unauthenticated data, at least to civilian users.